



Civic Meeting Report

Delaware County Council Meeting February 27th 2024

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=IQRH4JXzzw4
Publication Date	2024-02-28T03:26:48Z
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Delaware County Council Meeting Report

Meeting Date: February 2027

Body: Delaware County Council

1. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The meeting of the Delaware County Council was called to order by the presiding officer at [00:09:59](#). Public questions were directed to be sent to CountyCouncil@co.delaware.in.us.
- **Attendance:**
 - *Members Present:* Ms. Langan, Mr. Hughes, Mr. K (or Pant/Kerns), Mr. M (or Mel), Mr. Web, Mr. Wad (or Wyatt), Mr. Piper, and Mr. Freeman (noted during roll call).
 - *Presiding Officer:* Identified as the Council President.

2. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance led by Tommy [00:10:04](#).
- **Approval of Minutes:**

- Amended agenda to table the February 16th special meeting minutes: Approved by roll call vote.
- January 17th Executive Session minutes: Approved by roll call vote [00:11:34](#).
- January 23rd Council meeting minutes: Approved by roll call vote [00:11:53](#).
- February 5th Executive Session minutes: Approved by roll call vote [00:12:12](#).

3. Substantive Business & Board Action

- [00:12:26](#) **County General (1000) - Jail Transfer**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** County jail department.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Transfer involving correctional officer line items (backfilling positions) totaling zero net transfer.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.
- [00:13:41](#) **Prosecutor Department (137) Transfer**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Prosecutor's office.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Transfer of \$25.28 from Deputy Prosecutor to office remodel, accompanied by an invoice as previously requested by council members.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.
- [00:14:52](#) **Public Defenders (139) Transfer**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Public Defender department.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Backfilling investigator position (\$30,000, zero net transfer).
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.
- [00:15:20](#) **Local Public Health Services (1161) Transfer**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jamie (Health Fund).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Correction of a \$1,000 typo from travel expenses into an assistant registration salary line. Staff clarified that travel funds remain sufficient due to state health fund increases.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.
- [00:16:35](#) **LIT Jail (11745) Transfer**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jail department.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Backfilling correctional officer positions (\$33,428.92, zero net transfer) with adjustments reflecting updated staffing notes from Nancy.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.
- [00:18:10](#) **Circuit Court (138) Addendum Transfer**

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Circuit Court.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Backfilling assistant court reporter position (\$28,753, zero net transfer).
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.
- **00:18:50 Prosecutor (137) Addendum Transfer**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Prosecutor's office.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Transfer involving deputy prosecutor salary, office supplies (\$110.46), and computers (\$2,299.80). Addressed the purchase of 20 Dell computer monitors at \$115 each for attorneys to better view body camera and jail interview footage; older monitors moved to storage for investigators.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.
- **00:13:30 Auditor (126) Addendum Transfer**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Auditor's office.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Transfer (\$27,568.62) regarding a part-time position transitioning into an open full-time support deputy role, freeing up the part-time budget line.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.
- **00:23:41 Jail (145) Addendum Transfer**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jail department.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Backfilling corporal position (\$37,481, zero net transfer).
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.
- **00:24:24 EMS (155) Addendum Transfer**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** EMS department.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Backfilling paramedic positions with salary differentials (\$50,295.46 vs \$42,933.98) due to resignation timing, workman's comp leave, and accumulated vacation payout differences.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.
- **00:25:51 DCCC (9220) Addendum Transfer**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Community Corrections.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Backfilling HD case manager position (\$38,116.34, zero net transfer).
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.
- **00:26:43 Courts/Council Longevity Major Transfer**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Emily Anderson, Court Administrator.

- **Deliberation Summary:** Transfer of \$11,000 from Court longevity (Department 123) to Council longevity (Department 157) following an employee transfer from Title IV-D Court to the Clerk's office, ensuring longevity travels with the employee.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.
- **00:28:10 Clerk (125) Financial Transfer**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Rick (Clerk's Office).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Request for \$3,000 in bank fees due to the total failure of a newly implemented state child support money transfer system, requiring the office to return to local bank processing and check-writing.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.
- **00:30:14 Bridge Community Crossing Grant (9035) Financial Transfer**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Highway/Engineering department.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Appropriation of \$325,760.65 for Bridge 86 (County Road 650 East at Campbell Creek), which was omitted from Angie's encumbrance list. The wooden bridge is being replaced with a concrete/culvert structure. Closed for 120 days starting February 19th.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.
- **00:34:22 EMA Ball Brothers Grant (9209)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** EMA / Kyle Johnson (GIS).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Appropriation of \$5,000 from a Ball Brothers rapid grant to purchase a portable electronic message board trailer for traffic control during the solar eclipse and future emergency/hazmat scenes.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.
- **00:35:52 GIS (9207) Grant Appropriation**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Kyle (GIS).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Appropriation of \$5,000 for equipment (rechargeable, solar-paneled, Bluetooth-managed trailer sign).
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.
- **00:36:58 Medical and Healthcare Fund (4914)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Nancy (Jail Administration).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Transfer of \$20,000 for dental, eye care, and off-contract inmate medications. Extensive discussion regarding high-cost inmate medical treatments (one inmate costing \$77,000 for specialty drugs), loss of Medicaid benefits upon pre-trial detention, and pre-trial release/expediting court processes to mitigate jail medical liabilities.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.
 - **00:38:50 MIS Fund (1175) Transfer**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jail Administration.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Appropriation of \$10,000 from the MIS fund (reimbursed state funds restricted to jail purposes) to cover body scanner maintenance/warranty contracts and jail Wi-Fi/cell phone needs.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.
 - **00:45:57 Public Defender Supplemental (1200)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Shelley Harvey, Office Administrator.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Appropriation of \$3,000 for witness fees to cover an out-of-state expert witness (Michigan medical doctor) consulted for a specialized death case.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.
 - **00:48:07 Community Corrections Grant (9200)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jane Miranda, Community Corrections.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Grant appropriation totaling \$82,650 (\$1,250 peer recovery coach, \$4,100 FICA, \$7,200 incentives, \$8,100 K-9s/equipment) for a joint grant with adult probation. Incentives cover reward-based items like gift cards, clothing, and school backpacks for program participants.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.
 - **00:50:02 Ordinance 2024-D01: Salary Ordinance Update (Second Reading)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Council / Department heads.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Second reading updating part-time level four pay rates. Substantial debate occurred over whether salaries should be a flat \$20/hour or a sliding scale (\$20<U+2013>\$25/hour) determined solely at the discretion of elected officials/department heads. Council members expressed concern over losing council oversight, potential internal wage disparities with full-time staff, and lack of secondary administrative sign-off.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:**
 - *Amendment:* Moved by Mr. Wyatt, seconded by Mr. Hughes, to strike the sliding scale range and set Part-Time Level Four at a flat pay rate of \$20 per hour. **Approved by Voice Vote / Roll Call.**
 - *Main Motion:* Adoption of Ordinance 2024-D01 as amended. **Approved by Roll Call Vote.**
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4. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

(No general public comment speakers signed up or spoke during the designated public comment period; however, departmental reports were delivered.)

5. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - **Sheriff Tony Skinner (00:10:37 / 01:00:37):** Presented bi-annual reports covering jail meal costs (averaging \$1.72/meal due to reduced overtime and food sourcing), the QUAM Bush Pension fund growth (\$20.42M, 13.4% gain), federal and out-of-county inmate revenue (nearing \$700k last year, \$122k in January alone with 31 federal inmates), pre-trial probation/home detention diversion numbers, and deputy training hours (over 11,000 hours).
 - **Steve Foster, Building Superintendent (01:04:43):** Provided updates on recent facilities issues, including a basement gas leak next door, frozen air handler insurance repairs, completed roof projects (affirming no leaks in shingled roofs and addressing flat roof drainage/pipe condensation issues), and defended the integrity of the bidding process. He also highlighted staffing pressures and overtime/comp-time challenges for the 24/7 maintenance team managing county buildings.
 - **Council Comments (01:19:18 onwards):** Commended highway salt crews, the extension office annual meeting, and the Sheriff's Office following a ride-along. Councilman Wyatt announced that he has reached out to the state to request an independent audit of specific county departments to ensure fiscal transparency and restore public confidence.
 - **Adjournment:** Official motion to adjourn made by Dan, seconded by Eugene. **Approved by Voice Vote / Roll Call** prior to transitioning to a separate public hearing on solar farms **01:26:45**.
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